

Using Python for the Cloud and Big Data Analytics

The classical programming languages are not effective in fetching live streaming data from the Internet. Here's where versatile programming languages come to the rescue. Read on to understand how Python can be used for the cloud and for Big Data analytics.



As per international statistical reports, every day, WhatsApp gets around 1 million new user registrations and has 700 million active users. Around 30 billion messages get sent and 34 billion messages are received daily (source: statista.com). Twitter statistics reveal 350 million tweets daily and more than 500 million accounts. Data is growing at a rapid rate every moment, and there are predictions that the production and generation of data in 2020 will be 44 times more than 2009 levels (source: <http://wikibon.org/blog/big-data-statistics/>).

This data is unstructured in nature, which means that it is in different and heterogeneous formats. Such vast volumes are typically known as Big Data. Deep investigation of intelligent and meaningful patterns from such data is known as Big Data analytics. A number of researchers and scientists are working

in this domain using assorted technologies and tools. There are a number of ways in which live data can be obtained for research and development. One of these is getting data from 'open data portals'. These portals provide authentic data sets for research and development in multiple domains, which can be downloaded in multiple formats including XML, CSV, JSON and many others.

Prominent portals for fetching open data

- Databub is available at <http://databub.io/>
- Book-Crossing - <http://www.informatik.unifreiburg.de/~ciegler/BX/>
- World Health Organization - <http://www.who.int/research/en/>
- The World Bank - <http://data.worldbank.org/>
- NASA - <http://data.nasa.gov/>